

Think Puzzle Explore Template

What do you think you understand about A Growth Mindset?	List questions or puzzles that you have about A Growth Mindset.	Explore one or more of the questions and share your findings.
- A growth mindset is the belief that intelligence grows through effort and learning, as suggested in Chapter 1. Brains form new pathways every time we learn, and our capacity is never fixed. This is illustrated in Figure 1.1. - It is based on the idea of I can't do this yet. Dweck introduces the word yet as a path into the future rather than a dead end, as suggested at 0:22–0:40. - It looks like leaning into difficulty. Students with a growth mindset said I love a challenge when given hard problems, as shown in the video at 1:14–1:28. - It feels like curiosity. Chapter 3 notes babies naturally explore patterns with wonder, and growth mindset classrooms try to recapture that spirit. - It is fueled by recognizing effort, strategy, and persistence rather than talent or intelligence, as suggested in the video at 4:11–4:32.	- If mistakes spark brain growth, as suggested in Chapter 2, why do so many students, and teachers, still believe intelligence is fixed? - Dweck reports employers say graduates can't get through the day without an award, as suggested at 3:48–4:02. How do we shift from reward-dependency to intrinsic motivation? - Chapter 3 in the third paragraph shows students describe math as rules, while mathematicians describe it as beauty and patterns. What practices best close that perception gap and promote the mindset of growth to go from thinking of math as rules to the idea that it is observed patterns? - Chapter 4 in the second paragraph notes Finland delays formal math until age 7, which is in the second paragraph. Does later formal instruction actually produce more of a growth mindset long term long-term?	Question explored: <i>"What structural barriers prevent growth mindset classrooms from being universally adopted, despite the dramatic evidence?"</i> 1. The Science Is Recent and Slow to Reach Curriculum Brain plasticity research is relatively new. Chapter 1 In the first paragraph introduces the concept as relatively new, and the chapter later explains that brain-imaging technology has only recently revealed how the brain grows and changes from paragraphs 3-4. Thus, contradicting a long-held belief that the brain you're born with is fixed. Also, curricula change slowly, so most students never receive this information. Yet when they do, results are immediate. 2. Teacher Beliefs Are a Hidden Barrier Many teachers may hold fixed mindsets. For example, Chapter 3 notes in the first

• Mistakes are welcomed when it comes to growth mindsets. Chapter 2 cites Jason Moser's research showing the brain generates greater electrical activity when making errors. Mistakes are literally the brain's most active moments. • It looks like students engaging with errors rather than avoiding them. Growth-mindset brains lit up on scans; fixed-mindset brains disengaged entirely, as suggested in the video at 2:31–3:08. • In math, it means seeing the subject as a landscape of patterns to explore, not a fixed set of rules to memorize, as suggested in Chapter 4. • It feels like resilience. Students who taught their neurons form new connections during struggle showed sharp grade rebounds, as suggested at 5:44–6:22 in the video. • A growth mindset is also a classroom culture, not just an individual belief. When schools adopt it fully, even chronically underperforming students excel dramatically, as suggested at 7:01–8:17.	• Moser's study shows growth-mindset brains respond more to errors neurologically. What are the ethical implications of using brain scans to assess mindset? Chapter 2 says brain growth from struggle happens even without awareness of the mistake. How should teachers structure lessons to maximize productive struggle without causing shutdown? • How can teachers who hold their own fixed mindset about math authentically model growth mindset for students? • What structural barriers prevent growth mindset classrooms from being universally adopted, despite the dramatic evidence shown in Harlem and the South Bronx in the video at 7:17–8:17? • Dweck says praising intelligence has failed and we should stop at 4:15–4:21. Why is talent-based praise still so common in schools?	paragraph that math is uniquely treated as a performance subject, which is not treating it as a subject for growth, and it is a belief that teachers likely absorbed during their own schooling. Until teacher preparation programs embed neuroplasticity and growth mindset as core knowledge, this gap passes from teacher to student generation after generation. 3. Testing Culture Sends the Opposite Message Even when teachers embrace growth mindsets, the broader system undermines it. Chapter 3 describes in the second paragraph the United States pervasive testing culture that is more dominant in math than any other subject. Thus, this suggests students learn early because math means producing right answers under pressure, not growing. A six-year-old captured it perfectly. He thought math was too much answer time and not enough learning time. Chapter 1 in the second paragraph adds that pathways wash away after only superficial visits, yet one-time high-stakes tests remain the primary measure of learning. Until accountability systems reward growth and process—not just performance on a
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